

Refund and Complaints Policy

Sage and Stone Hair Studio · internal reference RC-2026-04 · effective 1 April 2026 · fictional document

Scope

This policy covers refunds, redo appointments, and goodwill gestures for services carried out at the Sage and Stone salon on Alder Street. It covers retail product returns in a separate section. It does not cover gift card disputes, which go to the studio manager.

The redo window

A client who is unhappy with a cut, colour, or treatment is entitled to a free redo appointment if they tell us within **fourteen days** of the original visit. The redo is carried out by the original stylist unless the client asks for someone else, which they may do without giving a reason.

- The redo is booked as a priority appointment and takes the next available slot with that stylist, normally within four working days.
- A redo is free of charge. We do not charge for the products used in it.
- A redo does not restart the fourteen-day window. There is one redo per original service.

Refunds

We offer a refund rather than a redo in three situations. A refund is returned to the original payment method and takes **five to seven working days** to appear.

- **Full refund.** The service was not delivered at all, or the result is materially different from what was agreed at consultation, and the client does not want a redo.
- **Half refund.** The client accepts the result but the appointment overran by more than forty-five minutes through our fault, or a stylist other than the one booked carried out the service without the client agreeing to the change.
- **Product cost only.** The client had a reaction to a product used in the service. The service fee stands; the product cost is returned and the reaction is recorded on the client's file.

We do not refund a service the client asked for against the stylist's written advice, where that advice was recorded on the consultation card and the client signed it. In that case a redo at half price is offered instead.

Colour corrections

A colour correction is a separate service, not a redo, when the original colour was applied elsewhere. Corrections are quoted after a patch test and a consultation, and the quote is valid for thirty days. A correction of our own colour work inside the fourteen-day window is a redo and is free.

Retail products

- Unopened retail products can be returned within **thirty days** with the receipt for a full refund.
- Opened products can be exchanged within thirty days if the client reacted badly to them. We do not refund an opened product that the client simply did not like.
- Gift cards are not refundable and do not expire.

How a complaint is handled

Every complaint is written down on the client's file the same day, with what happened, what the client asked for, and what was agreed. The client is told the reference number only if they ask for it.

- We acknowledge a complaint the same working day.
- We give a decision within **three working days**. If a decision needs the studio manager, we say so and give a date.
- A client may ask for the studio manager at any point. We do not require them to go through a specialist first.

Goodwill

Where nothing went wrong but the visit still fell short, a specialist may offer one goodwill gesture without asking the manager: a complimentary treatment add-on at the next visit, or twenty per cent off the next service. Anything larger than that, and any cash payment outside the refund rules above, needs the studio manager.

What we do not do

- We do not pay compensation for consequential loss, for example a missed event or travel booked around an appointment.
- We do not refund a no-show or a cancellation inside the notice period. See the services guide for the cancellation terms.
- We do not discuss one client's complaint with another client.